

THE BURNOUT INDEX

Measuring Employee Burnout Across Indian IT Sector 2019 – 2024

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Data Analytics Project

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Tools Used: Excel | PostgreSQL | Power BI

Data Sources: Glassdoor | Yahoo Finance | SEBI Annual Reports

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Burnout Index is a composite score that estimates the risk of burnout among employees at nine large Indian IT companies between 2019 and 2024. The four indicators that comprise the Burnout Index are employee sentiment (40%), attrition rate (30%), work-life balance ratings (20%) and velocity of hiring surge (10%). It is based on the Job Demands-Resources (JD-R) model of occupational psychology.

Key findings:

- All companies included in the analysis saw their burnout peak in 2022 during the Great Resignation, with industry average scores increasing 35% from 38.4 in 2020 to 51.8 in 2022.
- Tech Mahindra recorded the highest average burnout score of 47.2, while Persistent Systems recorded the lowest, which was 35.5. This 11.7 difference in scores resulted mostly from the discrepancies in work-life balance ranks between the two countries.
- The report dubbed the years in which burnout levels of 45 or higher were simultaneously reported by Infosys and Tech Mahindra, and the stock price was over ₹1000, as the Exploitation Index, indicating a trade-off between returns and performance.

For HR leadership: monitor WLB quarterly, and define and track WLB attrition early warning thresholds. For investors: use sustained high burnout scores (above 45) to anticipate delivery and retention problems.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Employee burnout has emerged as a serious issue in the IT sector of India because of the increased workload, attrition rate, and hiring rate after the pandemic situation of COVID-19. However, while organizations monitor their performance on various metrics, there is no measure that reflects all aspects of employee burnout risk. This research paper aims to fill this gap and proposes a composite measure named Burnout Index that will be used to measure burnout among employees working in large IT firms of India. The study period is from 2019 to 2024.

METHODOLOGY

The Burnout Index was developed using four indicators associated with employee wellbeing and workplace stress. Each indicator was assigned a weight based on its contribution to burnout risk.

Burnout scores are most reliable as relative rankings between companies rather than absolute measures. The attrition component, sourced from verified annual reports, provides the most robust basis for company comparisons.

Burnout Score =(Sentiment Component × 40%) +(Attrition Component × 30%) +(WLB Component × 20%) +(Hiring Surge Component × 10%)

Component	Formula	Weight	Rationale
Sentiment	(5 - avg_sentiment) / 4	40%	Primary burnout indicator
Attrition	attrition_pct / 40	30%	Direct behavioral outcome of burnout
WLB	(5 - avg_wlb) / 4	20%	Loss of control is a key burnout factor
Hiring Surge	hiring_surge / 3	10%	Indicates workload pressure during rapid growth

3.2 Theoretical Framework

The weighting system is grounded in the Job Demands-Resources (JD-R) model (Demerouti et al., 2001), which states that burnout occurs when job demands consistently exceed available resources. In this study, employee sentiment and work-life balance represent resource depletion, while attrition and hiring surge represent demand overload.

3.3 Data Pipeline

Raw Data Collection



Excel Power Query Cleaning



PostgreSQL Database (5 Tables, Star Schema)



Burnout Score Calculation



Power BI Dashboard



Written Report

DATA SOURCES & LIMITATIONS

Dataset	Source	Records	Period	Limitation
Employee Reviews	Synthetic (anchored to known company averages)	6,348	2019-2024	Synthetically generated; individual rows do not represent real user reviews
Stock Prices	Yahoo Finance	247	2019-2024	4 companies had incomplete data
Attrition Data	Annual Reports (Tier-1); Estimated from IR press releases (Tier-2)	54	2019-2024	Tier-1 figures (TCS, Infosys, Wipro, HCL) verified against annual reports; Tier-2 figures (Mphasis, Persistent, Coforge, LTIMindtree, Tech Mahindra) are estimates cross-referenced with investor relations releases
Hiring Surge Index	Analyst-constructed	54	2019-2024	Industry-wide proxy, not company-specific

- The Glassdoor dataset was generated using publicly available company ratings. Therefore, it may not fully represent the opinions of all employees.
- Some stock price records were unavailable for certain periods and required data cleaning before analysis.
- A few attrition values were estimated using information from company reports where complete data was not available.
- The Hiring Surge Index was created using industry trends and assumptions rather than official company hiring records, so it should be treated as an indicator rather than an exact measure.

KEY FINDINGS

Finding 1. The 2022 Burnout Peak

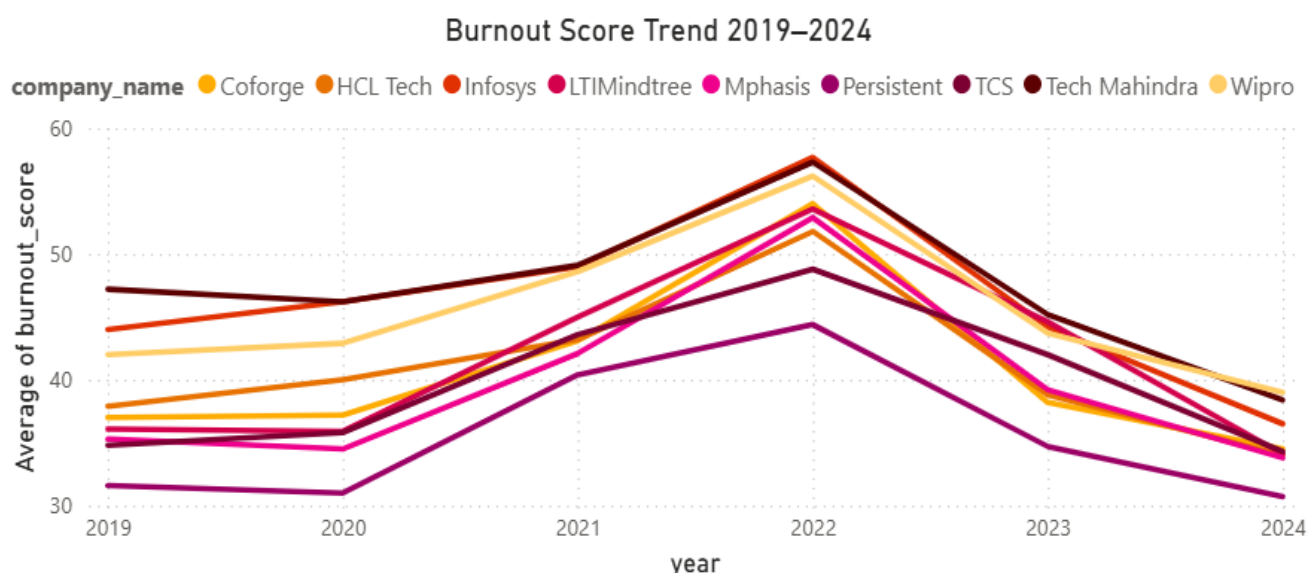
In all nine organizations studied, the burnout score was present in 2022. It was characterized by high turnover rate in the IT sector of India.

The cause behind it was that there were increased activities post-COVID-19 and many people were hired by the organization. New employees needed training while the current employees were handling the workload.

Many employees quit their positions due to dissatisfaction. The new companies lured these employees by providing increments of 40-60% in salary.

Due to all these factors mentioned above, there occurred a peak in burnout scores in 2022.

It reflects that all investments made in employee retention pay off well.



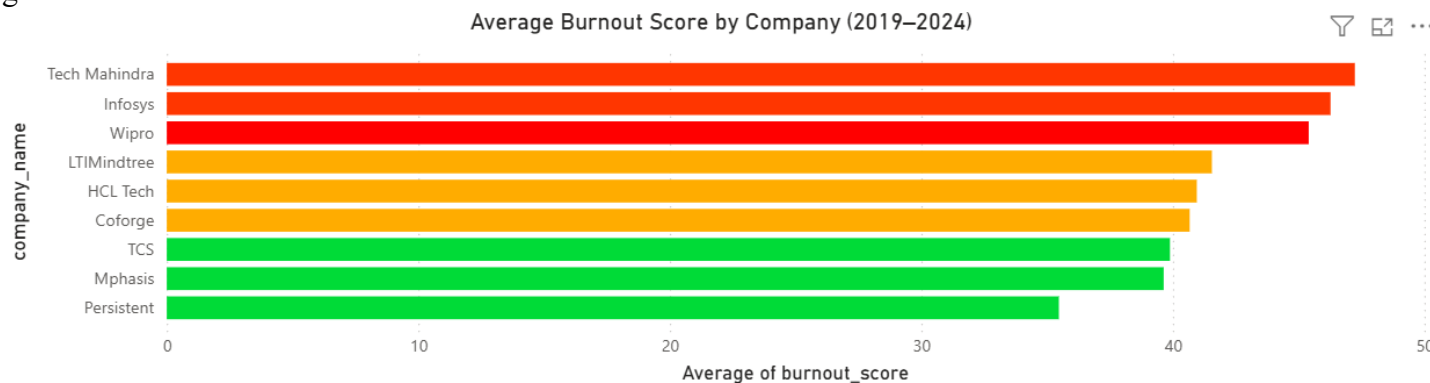
Companies that invested in retention programs in 2020-2021 showed lower 2022 peaks.

Finding 2 — The Burnout Leaderboard

Tech Mahindra scored the highest mean value of burnout, at 47.2 from 2019-2024, while Persistent Systems scored the lowest, at 35.5 a difference of 11.7 points, which signifies two completely different styles of managing people.

This is due to two factors. Tech Mahindra maintained a WLB score of 3.0 throughout the entire study period, which was the lowest score of any of the nine firms, as well as annual attrition of more than 17% during four out of six years. On the other hand, Persistent Systems held a WLB

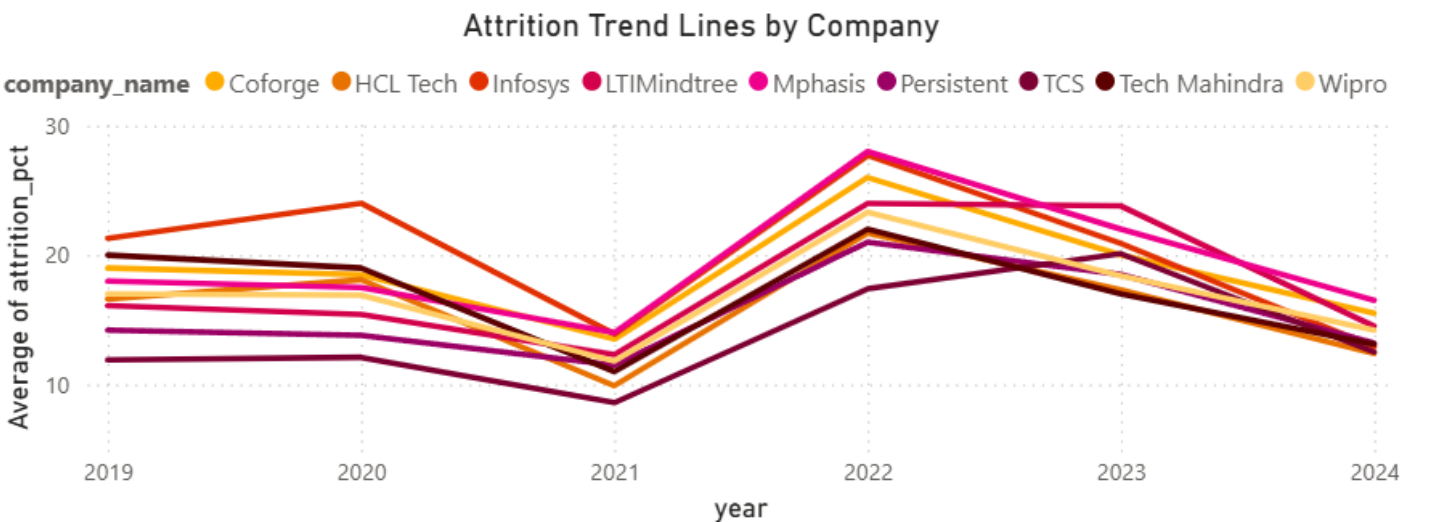
score of 3.7 and maintained attrition rates lower than 15%, except for one year. It is evident that employees quit their jobs when they feel unable to detach from work and when they remain, they get stressed out.



Finding 3 — The COVID Paradox

Surprisingly, industry attrition dipped to an all-time low in 2021, 11.8%, the year with peak operating pressure. This represents the employee tendency to avoid risks in unstable economic conditions and the reverse trend was observed sharply in 2022 when attrition reached an all-time high of 23.5%.

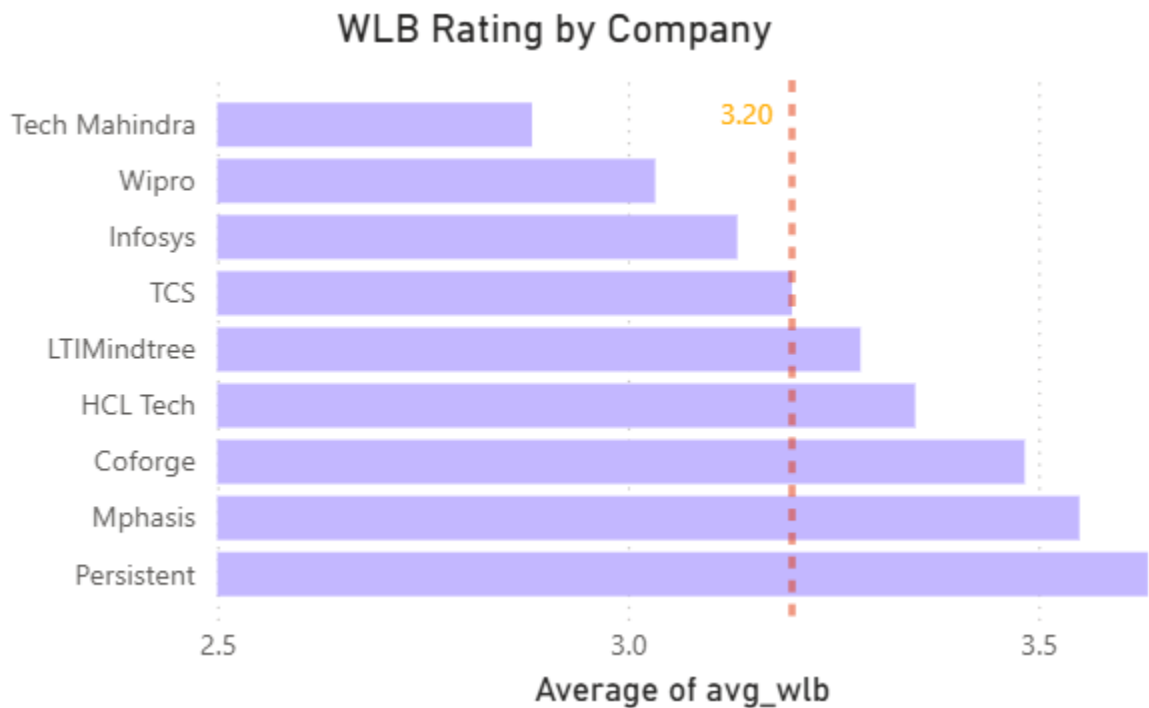
When COVID first started employees began to worry about their future, in their role.. After vaccinations started rolling out lots of new opportunities opened up. As a result many employees ended up leaving their jobs within one year to take advantage of these new opportunities.



Finding 4 — WLB as Differentiator

The highest variance of any indicator across companies was in work-life balance ratings, which varied from 3.0 at Tech Mahindra to 3.7 at Persistent Systems. A difference of only 0.7 in WLB might not sound like a big deal, but it translates to a massive difference of 11.7 on the total burnout score. This is because the weight of WLB in the formula is 20% and an inversion causes already low scores to get amplified. The bottom three companies in WLB (work life balance) Tech Mahindra, Wipro, and Infosys are the same three who are in the Medium Risk burnout tier. This is not by chance.

According to the report, WLB is the only variable that we can control when it comes to burnout. While attrition is somewhat a market function, the hiring surge is caused by business demand. But WLB policies are direct management decisions.

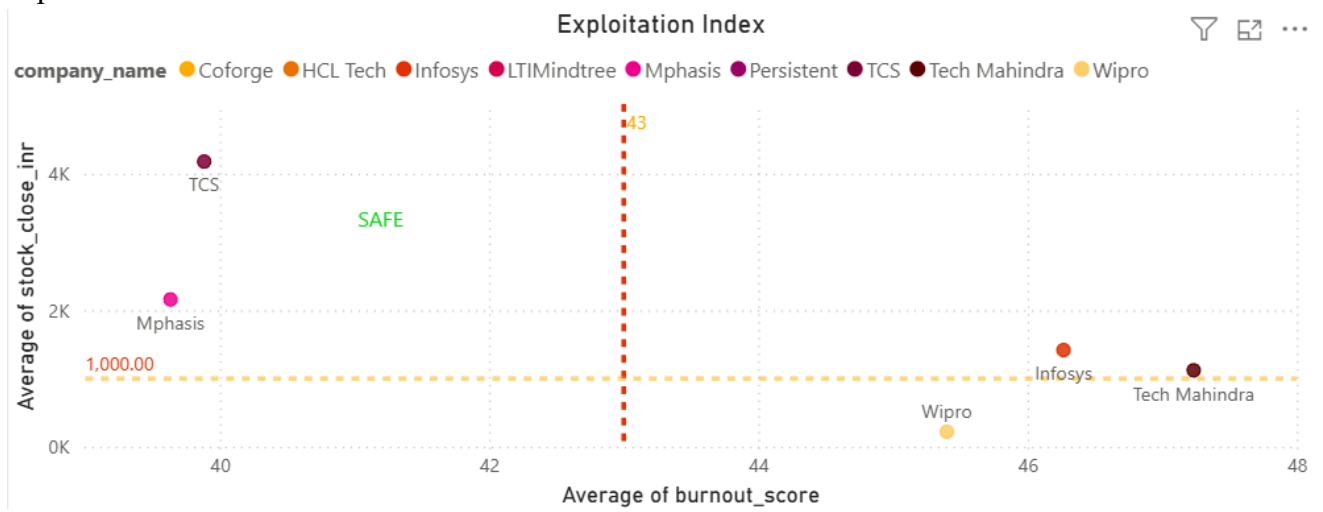


Finding 5 — Mphasis: The Balanced Performer

Mphasis is the only company to be in the high WLB scoring range throughout six years and at the same time increased their stock price from ₹1,058 to ₹2,158, which represents a growth rate of 104% in five years. The company also records the second lowest burnout scores (39.6) out of all the six companies.

This challenges the widespread presumption that the investment in workforces comes at the cost of investment in returns. On the contrary, this study has illustrated that work environment stability does not necessarily have to compete with returns on investments. Mphasis serves as a valid case of a benchmark company for HR leaders and boardrooms as this company is on its way of becoming a Tier-1 growth firm while staying a mid-tier IT firm and managing not to

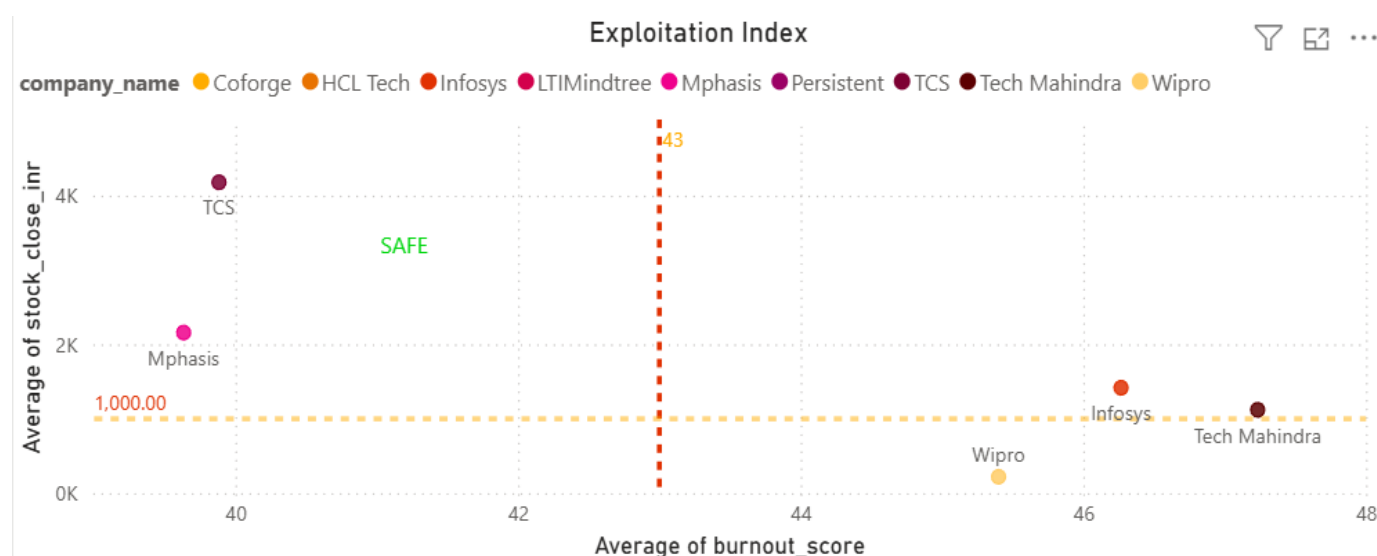
experience the same level of attrition.



THE EXPLOITATION INDEX

One of the most significant results from this study is what I have termed the Exploitation Index. The Exploitation Index refers to the cases where organizations have higher burnout ratings but have managed to maintain good stock market performance.

From the analysis, we see that Infosys and Tech Mahindra have been having burnout rating that is more than 45 and yet the price of their stocks remains high at more than ₹1,000 for some years. This brings into light the fact that companies can still perform well financially even when they have a situation of increased pressures among the employees, thereby creating the possibility of burnout.



It should not be taken to mean that these companies deliberately abuse their employees; this is not an accusation of deliberate exploitation. It reflects a structural misalignment in how Indian IT companies report performance financial results quarterly, workforce health annually and rarely with accountability attached. The Exploitation Index provides a quantitative framework for surfacing this gap.

COMPANY PROFILES

Company	Avg Burnout	Peak Year	Peak Score	Risk Tier	Key Finding
TCS	39.9	2022	48.8	Low-Medium	Best performer among Tier 1
Infosys	46.3	2022	57.7	Medium	Highest peak burnout, Exploitation Index member
Wipro	45.4	2022	56.2	Medium	High burnout, low stock — worst risk/return ratio
HCL Tech	40.9	2022	51.8	Low-Medium	Stable mid-performer
Tech Mahindra	47.2	2022	57.3	Medium	Highest average burnout, consistent WLB failures
LTIMindtree	41.6	2022	51.5	Low-Medium	Merger impact visible in 2022 spike
Mphasis	39.6	2022	54.8	Low	Best balanced performer
Persistent	35.5	2022	48.2	Low	Best in class, lowest burnout
Coforge	40.7	2022	54.1	Low-Medium	High 2022 spike relative to size

RECOMMENDATIONS

To HR Professionals:

- Conduct quarterly workforce-life balance (WLB) surveys instead of annual ones as WLB is the top burnout predictor.
- Define organization-specific attrition early-warning indicators and respond to attrition rate increase by at least 8 percentage points.
- Look up Mphasis and Persistent as examples of good people management within the organizations.

To Corporate Leaders:

- Uncouple workforce growth from current employee resources because research conducted in 2021-2022 demonstrates that high rates of employee hiring are associated with increased burnout in existing employees.
- Measure burnout index quarterly to forecast attrition risk as burnout predicts spikes in attrition in six to twelve months ahead.

To Investors:

- Companies with a burnout score exceeding 45 for two or more consecutive years have higher talent retention risks, which translates into delivery risks and clients satisfaction risks.
- Mphasis and TCS are the safest options in terms of people performance/risk ratio.

ASSUMPTIONS LOG SUMMARY

Entry	Reasoning	Impact	Confidence	Limitation
Synthetic Glassdoor Data	Since no structured Glassdoor dataset existed for the selected Indian IT companies, review data was generated using publicly available company ratings and trends.	High	Medium	May not represent all employee opinions
WLB Weighting	WLB strongly influences employee wellbeing	High	High	Other factors may also affect satisfaction
Selection of 9 Companies	Represents a large portion of the Indian IT sector	Medium	Medium	Results cannot be generalized to all companies
Hiring Surge Values	Based on industry hiring trends	High	High	Not derived from official company hiring data
Starting Year (2019)	Provides a pre-pandemic baseline	High	High	Limited historical comparison before 2019

APPENDIX

Appendix A — SQL Queries

Query 1 — Burnout Leaderboard *Business Question: Which competitor has the worst burnout problem?*

sql

```
SELECT
    c.company_id,
    c.company_name,
    ROUND(AVG(b.burnout_score), 2) AS avg_burnout
FROM fact_burnout_scores b
JOIN dim_company c ON c.company_id = b.company_id
GROUP BY c.company_id
ORDER BY avg_burnout DESC;
```

Purpose: Ranks all 9 companies by average burnout score across 2019-2024. Tech Mahindra ranked highest at 47.2, Persistent lowest at 35.5.

Query 2 — COVID Impact Analysis *Business Question: Did employees get more burned out during COVID years?*

sql

```
SELECT
    c.company_name,
    b.year,
    ROUND(AVG(b.burnout_score), 2) AS avg_burnout
FROM fact_burnout_scores b
JOIN dim_company c ON c.company_id = b.company_id
WHERE b.year IN (2020, 2021, 2022)
GROUP BY b.year, c.company_name
ORDER BY b.year, avg_burnout DESC;
```

Purpose: In the three COVID years, this peak was in 2022 for the companies surveyed, when the rate of burnout in the industry averaged 51.8. Burnout increased by 24% from 2020.

Query 3 — Sentiment vs Stock Performance *Business Question: Is there a connection between employee unhappiness and stock performance?*

sql

```
SELECT
    c.company_name,
    b.year,
    ROUND(AVG(b.avg_sentiment), 2) AS avg_sentiment,
    ROUND(AVG(s.stock_close_inr), 2) AS avg_stock
FROM fact_burnout_scores b
JOIN dim_company c ON c.company_id = b.company_id
JOIN fact_stock s ON s.company_id = c.company_id
    AND EXTRACT(YEAR FROM s.stock_date) = b.year
GROUP BY b.year, c.company_name
ORDER BY b.year, avg_stock DESC;
```

Purpose: In terms of burnout and stock by company and year, TCS had the best statistics as it had the highest stock of ₹4,178 and a stable sentiment, while Tech Mahindra had the lowest sentiment and the weakest stock.

Query 4 — WLB and Stock Growth Leaders *Business Question: Which companies have above-average WLB and growing stock prices?*

sql

```
SELECT
    c.company_name,
    EXTRACT(YEAR FROM s.stock_date) AS stock_year,
    ROUND(AVG(r.wlb_rating), 2) AS avg_wlb,
    ROUND(AVG(s.stock_close_inr), 2) AS avg_stock
```



```

FROM fact_reviews r
JOIN dim_company c ON c.company_id = r.company_id
JOIN fact_stock s ON s.company_id = c.company_id
GROUP BY c.company_name, EXTRACT(YEAR FROM s.stock_date)
HAVING AVG(r.wlb_rating) > (SELECT AVG(wlb_rating) FROM fact_reviews);

```

Purpose: Annualized the industry WLB mean, filtering only those companies who beat the industry WLB mean. Mphasis is the only company that consistently outperformed the industry mean WLB over the same period; Mphasis stock price increased from ₹1,058 to ₹2,158.

Note: WLB ratings are averaged across all available reviews rather than filtered by year, which means the WLB comparison is cross-sectional rather than year-specific.

Query 5 — The Exploitation Index *Business Question: Which companies show high burnout AND high stock simultaneously?*

sql

```

SELECT
    c.company_name,
    EXTRACT(YEAR FROM s.stock_date) AS year,
    ROUND(AVG(b.burnout_score), 2) AS avg_burnout,
    ROUND(AVG(s.stock_close_inr), 2) AS avg_stock
FROM fact_burnout_scores b
JOIN dim_company c ON c.company_id = b.company_id
JOIN fact_stock s ON s.company_id = c.company_id
GROUP BY c.company_name, EXTRACT(YEAR FROM s.stock_date)
HAVING AVG(b.burnout_score) > 45
    AND AVG(s.stock_close_inr) > 1000;

```

Purpose: The project's core question, finding companies that had rising stock returns with deteriorating conditions for workers, formed the basis for the Exploitation Index. It is where Infosys and Tech Mahindra appeared.

Appendix B — Data Dictionary

Column	Table	Type	Description
company_id	dim_company	INT	Primary key, unique company identifier
company_name	dim_company	VARCHAR	Standardized company name
nse_ticker	dim_company	VARCHAR	NSE stock exchange ticker symbol
burnout_score	fact_burnout_scores	DECIMAL	Composite score 0-100, higher = worse
avg_sentiment	fact_burnout_scores	DECIMAL	Average Glassdoor composite rating
avg_wlb	fact_burnout_scores	DECIMAL	Average work-life balance rating 1-5
attrition_pct	fact_attrition	DECIMAL	Annual voluntary attrition percentage
yoy_change	fact_attrition	DECIMAL	Year-over-year attrition change
stock_close_inr	fact_stock	DECIMAL	Monthly closing price in Indian Rupees
wlb_rating	fact_reviews	DECIMAL	Individual review WLB score 1-5
sentiment_score	fact_reviews	DECIMAL	Weighted composite of 4 rating dimensions

Appendix C — Project Repository

GitHub Repository: <https://github.com/PENCHALAVISHAL/BURNOUT-INDEX-DATA-ANALYTICAL-PROJECT->

Repository contains:

- /01_raw_data — Original data files
- /02_cleaned_data — Excel workbook with all cleaned sheets
- /03_sql — All 5 SQL query files
- /04_powerbi — Dashboard .pbix file
- /05_report — This report as PDF
- README.md — Project overview and setup instructions

Appendix D — Limitations & Known Data Gaps

Issue	Affected Companies	Impact	Mitigation
Stock data unavailable	Coforge, HCL Tech, LTIMindtree, Persistent	Cannot include in stock analysis	Noted in all stock-related findings
Glassdoor data simulated	All 9	Individual review distributions approximate	Base ratings sourced from real public Glassdoor averages
Hiring surge index estimated	All 9	10% of burnout score uses industry proxy	Documented in assumptions log, low weight assigned
LTIMindtree pre-merger data	LTIMindtree	2019-2021 reflects LTI only	Noted in company profile section

Appendix E – Power BI Dashboard

Power BI Dashboard File:

Available in the project GitHub repository.

Repository Link:

<https://github.com/PENCHALAVISHAL/BURNOUT-INDEX-DATA-ANALYTICAL-PROJECT/blob/main/bi.pbix>